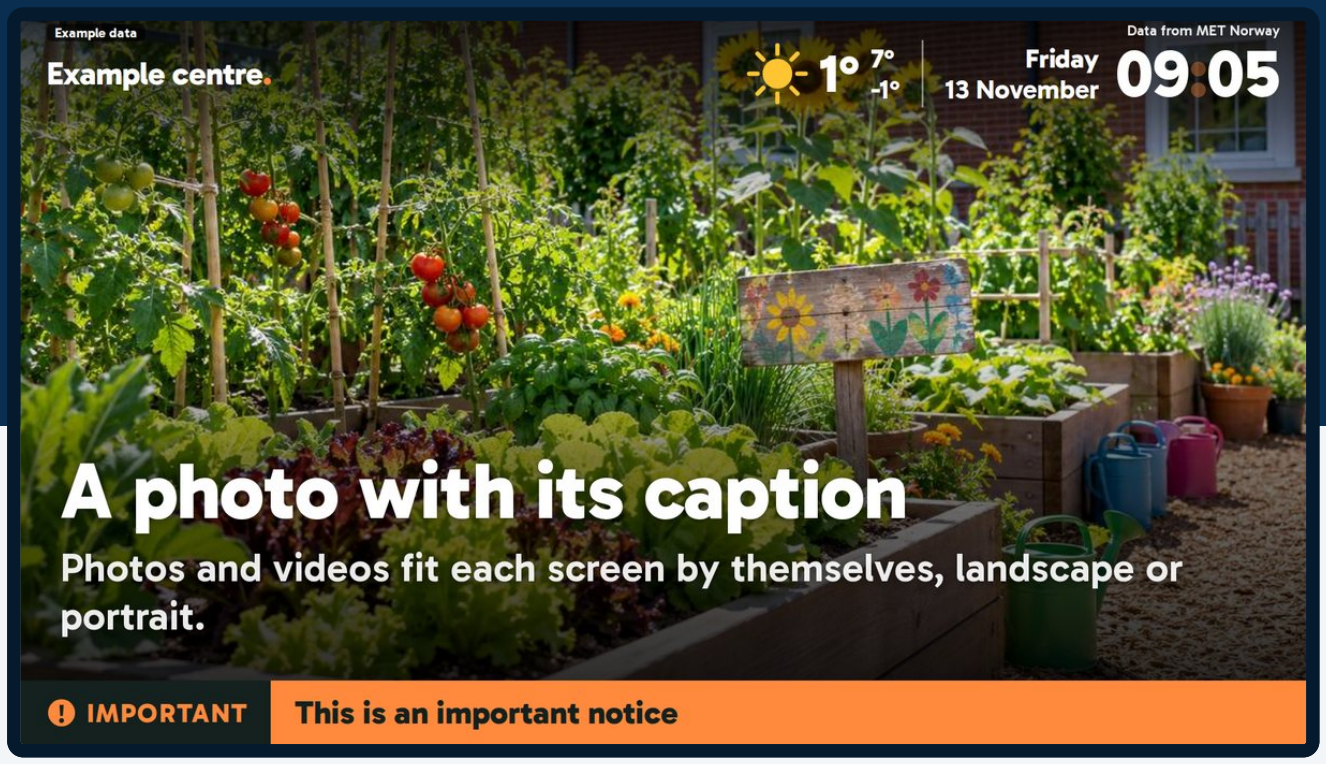
Hechauka
por OKSIGENIA

User's guide

The information screens of your centre, run from Moodle.



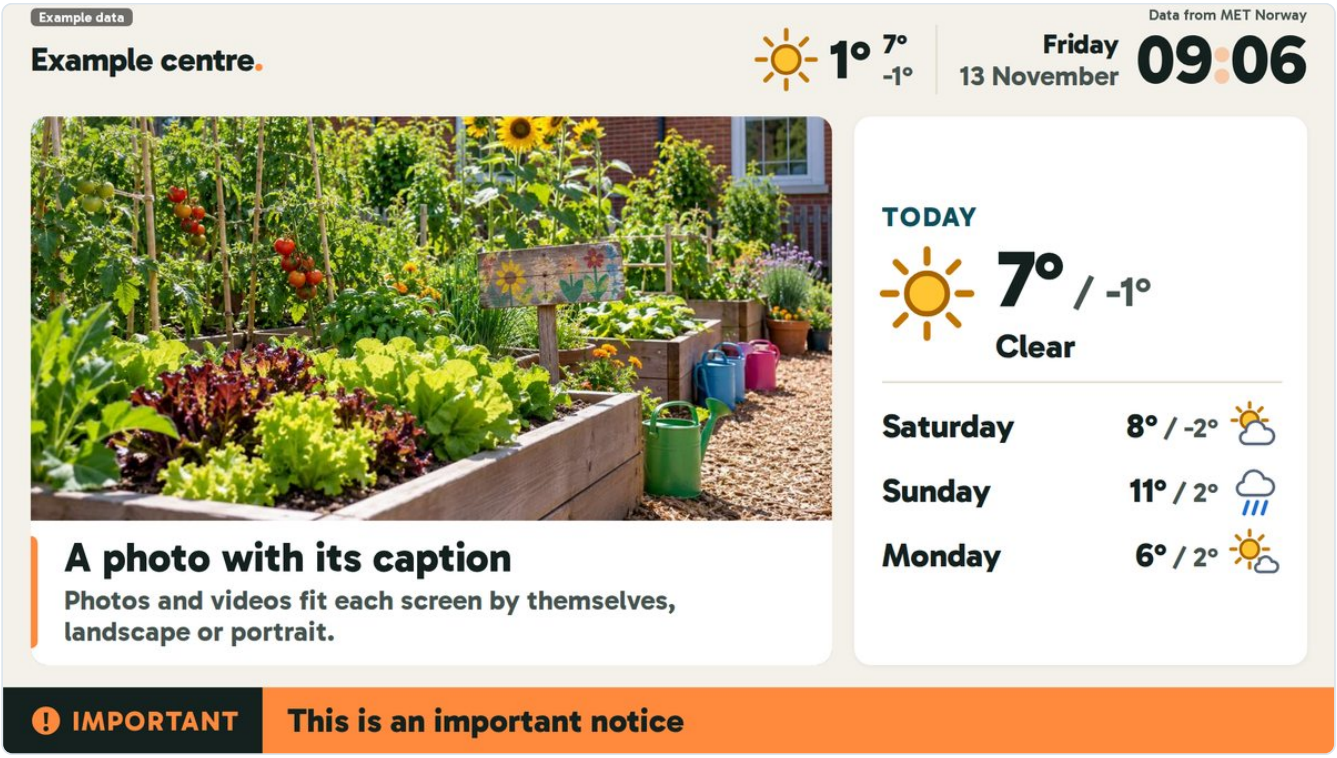
For whoever runs the screens and whoever publishes on them. With an example centre and example data.

oksigenia.com

What Hechauka is

Hechauka runs the information screens of a centre from its Moodle: notices, photos, videos, events, the menu of the day, the agenda, the weather and whatever else is needed. Each screen shows it so that it can be read from afar, and it fills itself with what Moodle already knows, even if nobody publishes anything.

This guide is for whoever runs the screens and whoever publishes on them. All the pictures are of an example centre, with example data.



A screen of the example centre: a photo, the weather of the coming days and the important notice at the bottom.

Hechauka works the same for a school, a university, an academy, a town council or a company: what changes is what each one publishes.

What you need

- **A Moodle**, version 4.5 or later, with the plugin installed. Whoever runs the Moodle installs it.
- **A screen with internet.** A television or a monitor with a browser will do, or any screen with a small device plugged in (a mini computer or a Raspberry Pi). The screen does not need to be on the same network as the Moodle: it only has to reach it over the internet. That is why a centre with several buildings, or with a camp in another town, runs everything from the same Moodle.
- **Someone to run the screens.** They do not need to be a Moodle administrator: the plugin brings its own permissions (further down, in Who does what).

The first time

The first time you go into «Screens», the panel welcomes you with **Get started**: five steps with the screen in sight, changing as you choose.

1. **What your centre is.** A school, a university, an academy, an administration, a company or something else. It does not change what you can do; only what is suggested to begin with.
2. **Your brand.** The name, the logo and the colours are taken from your Moodle. You can change them.
3. **What comes by itself.** Which sources of your Moodle come out on the screens: the calendar, the news, the menu, the library, the deadlines. Each one says what it brings right now.
4. **Where the centre is.** For the weather on the screens.
5. **The first screen.** The address to open on the screen.

What you touch is saved by itself. You can leave it half done: the panel reminds you of what is missing.

The example

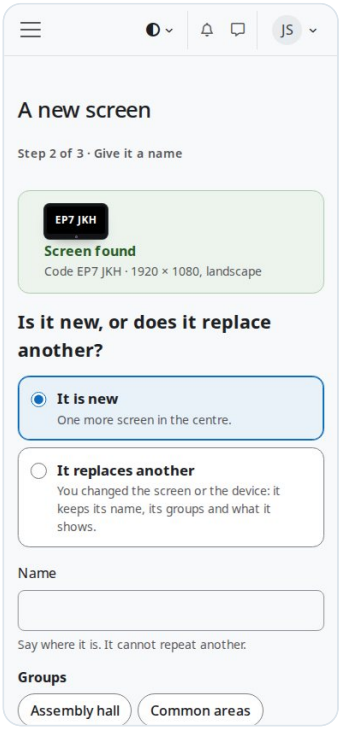
A Moodle where Hechauka has just been installed brings an **example**: an important notice, notices, photos, an event, a table and the ticker, and each piece explains what it does. That way neither the panel nor the first screen starts empty. While any of the example is left, the screens say so with a small label, «Example data».

When you start with your own, press **Take the example out** in the panel. If you change a piece of the example, it stays as yours.

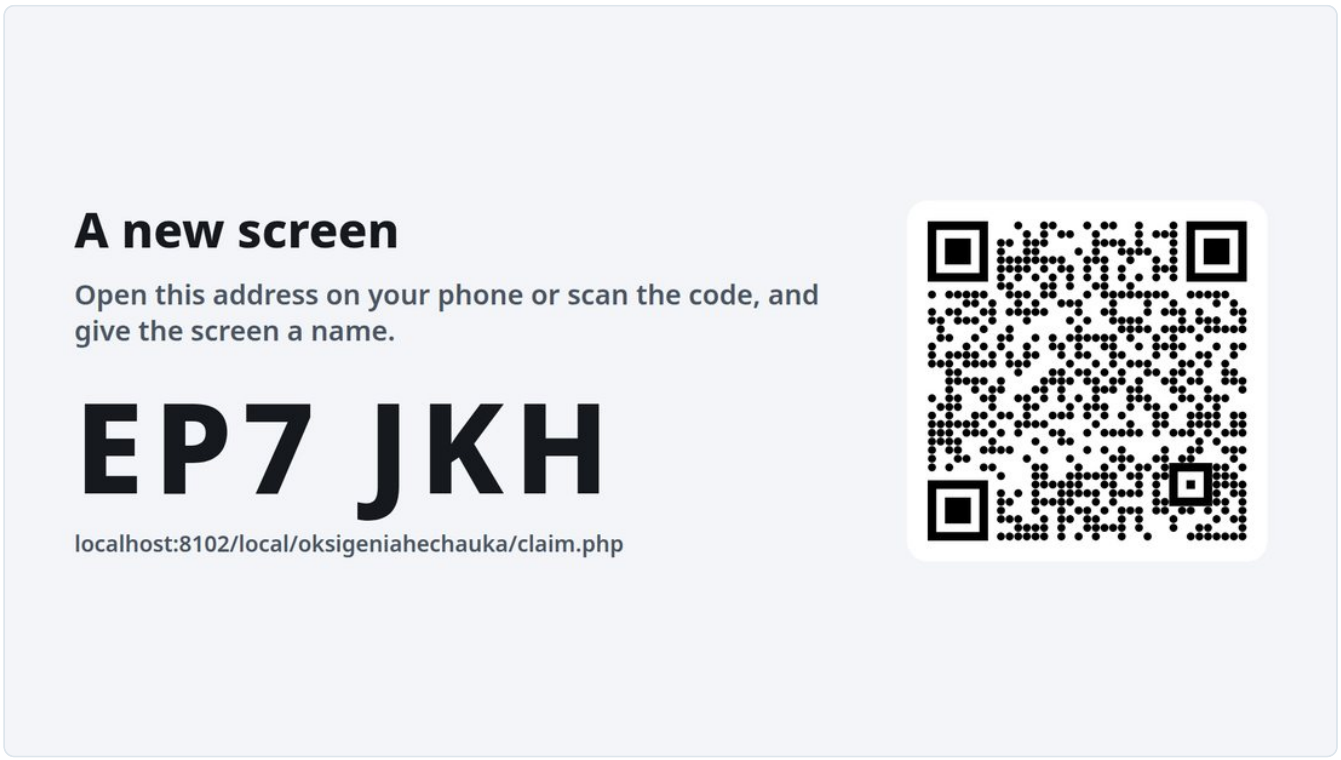
Setting up a screen

1. Open on the screen the address the panel gives (in «Get started», or in «Screens and groups» with **Add a screen**). The screen shows a code and a QR.
2. Scan the QR with your phone, or open the address shown on your phone and type the code.
3. Say whether **it is new** or **it replaces another** (if you have changed the television or the device, it keeps the name, the groups and what the old one showed). Give it a name that says where it is and, if you like, its groups.

In a few seconds the screen starts showing what is its. The code changes every few minutes: always use the one you see.



What you see on the phone.

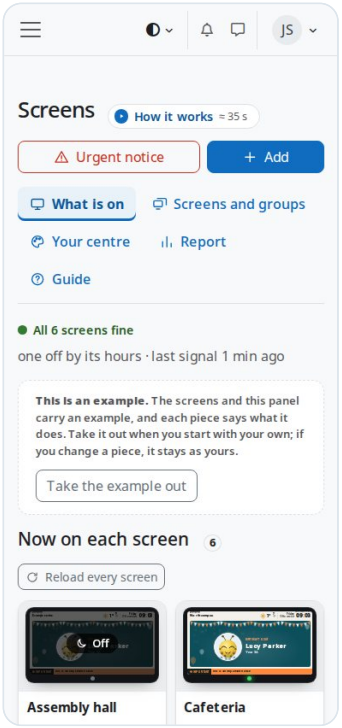


What a new screen shows.

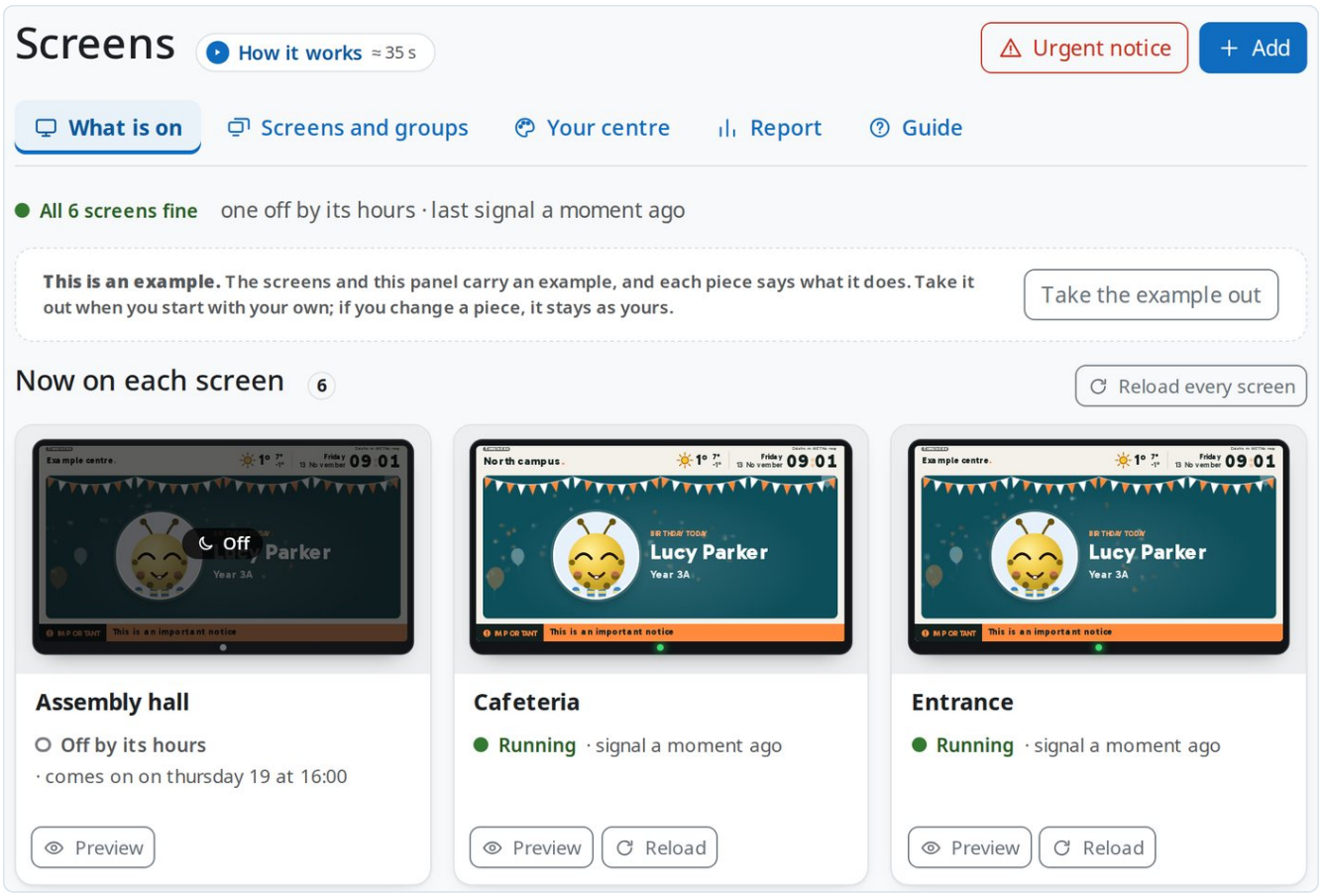
What is on

The first tab of the panel shows each screen with what it has now, whether it is running and, below, everything published: when it comes out and where. From there each thing is changed, hidden, duplicated or taken off.

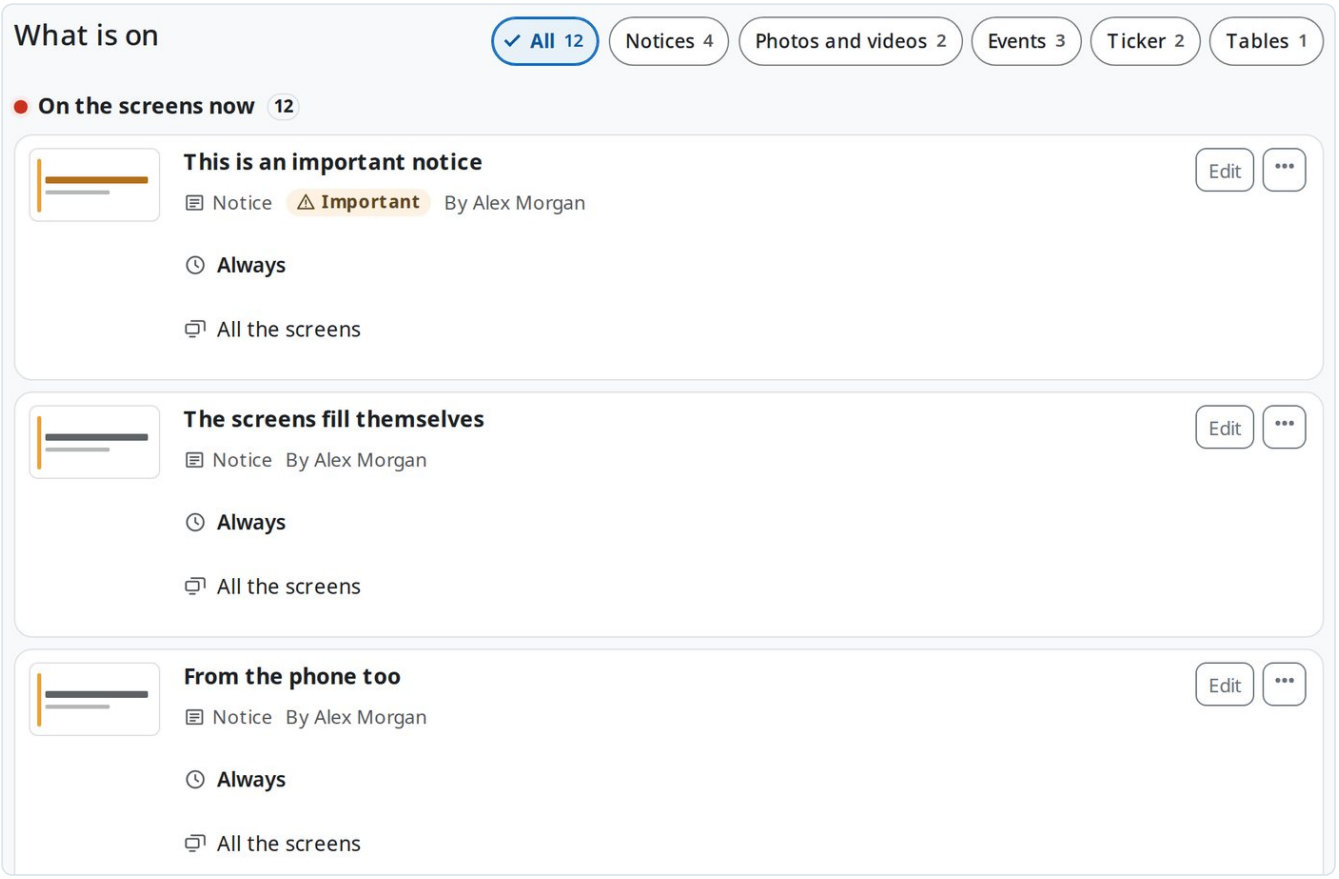
On the phone, the same panel fits in one column.



The panel on the phone.



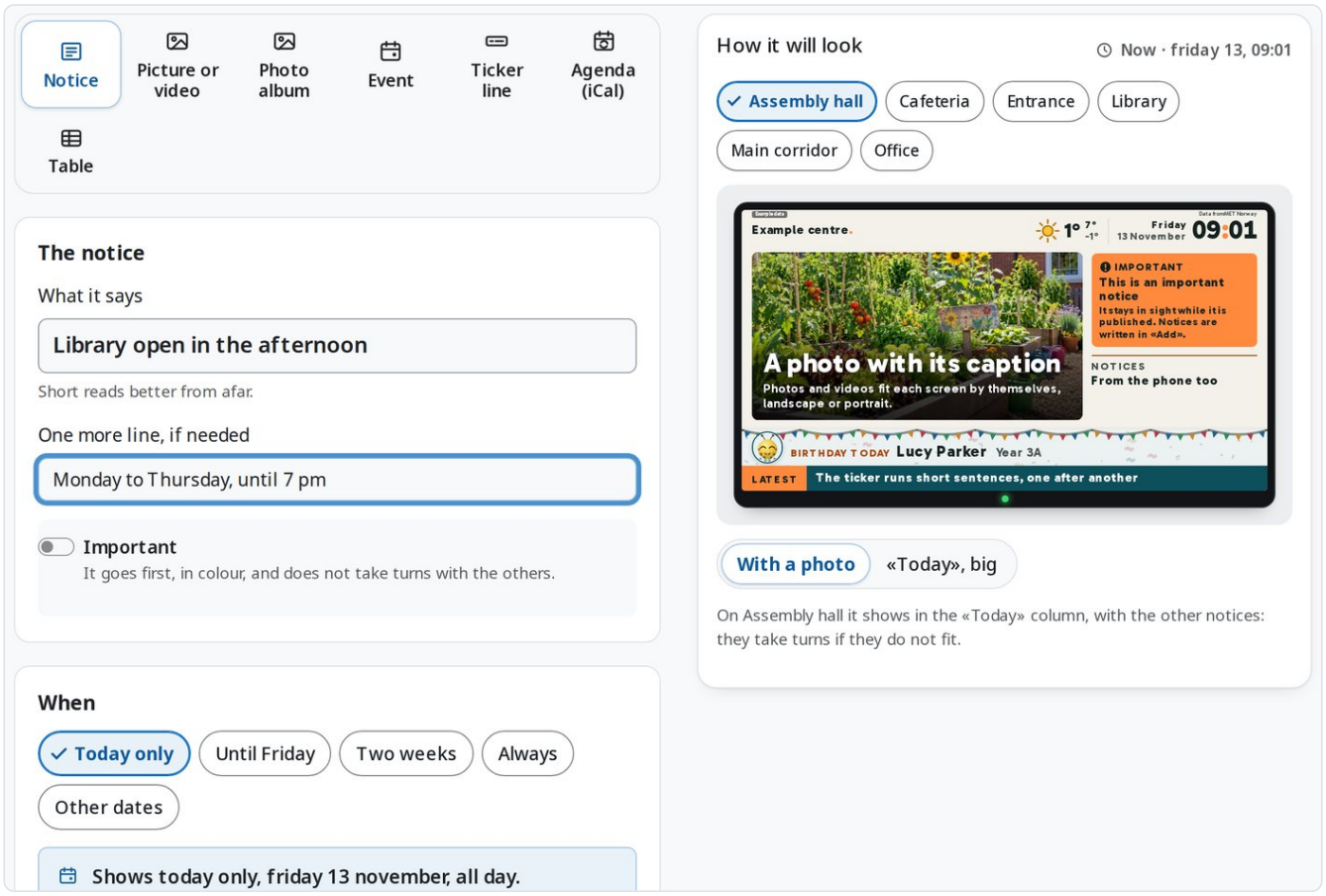
The panel, with each screen and its state.



What is published, with when it comes out and where.

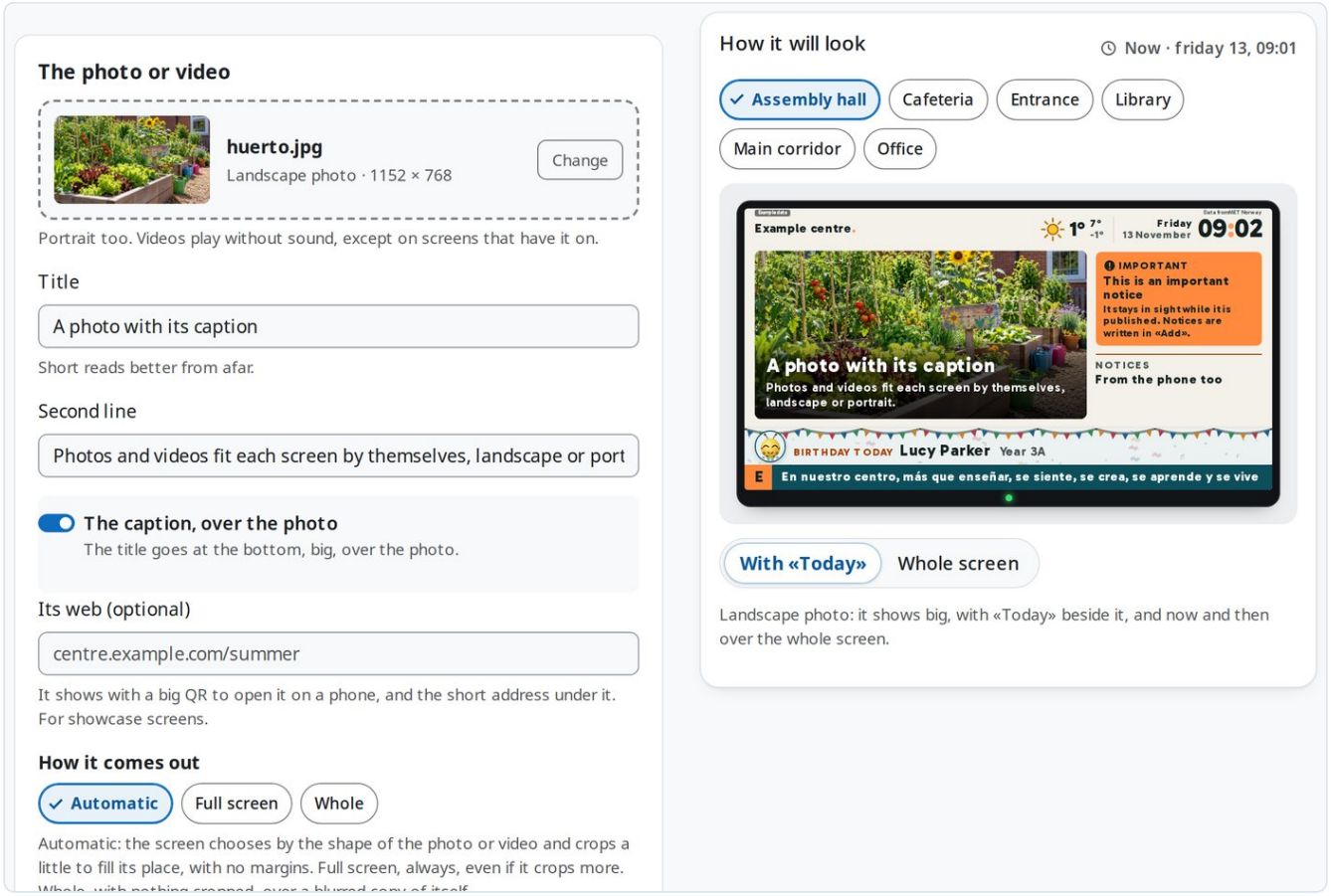
Add

Add opens a form with the screen beside it: as you type, you see how it will look. At the top you choose the kind of content.



A notice, with its preview.

- **Notice.** A short title and one more line if needed. If it is **important**, it stays in sight on all its screens while it is published.
- **Picture or video.** It fits each screen by itself, landscape or portrait. In **How it comes out** you choose: automatic (it crops a little to fill the space), whole or full screen. Videos are prepared on the server so that they play well on any screen.
- **Photo album.** Several photos that come out one at a time, without pushing everything else out.
- **Event.** With its day and its time; it comes out on that day and in the agenda of the days before. Its category gives it a colour.
- **Ticker line.** A short sentence for the strip at the bottom.
- **Agenda (iCal).** The address of a calendar (Google Calendar, Outlook, Nextcloud…). Its events come out by themselves and are read again every few minutes.
- **Table.** The address of a spreadsheet published as CSV (Google Sheets, OneDrive, Nextcloud) or of a list in JSON: timetables, shifts, rooms, results. It has its own slide, by pages. Put the important columns first: from afar they may not all fit. There is a model to download in the same form.

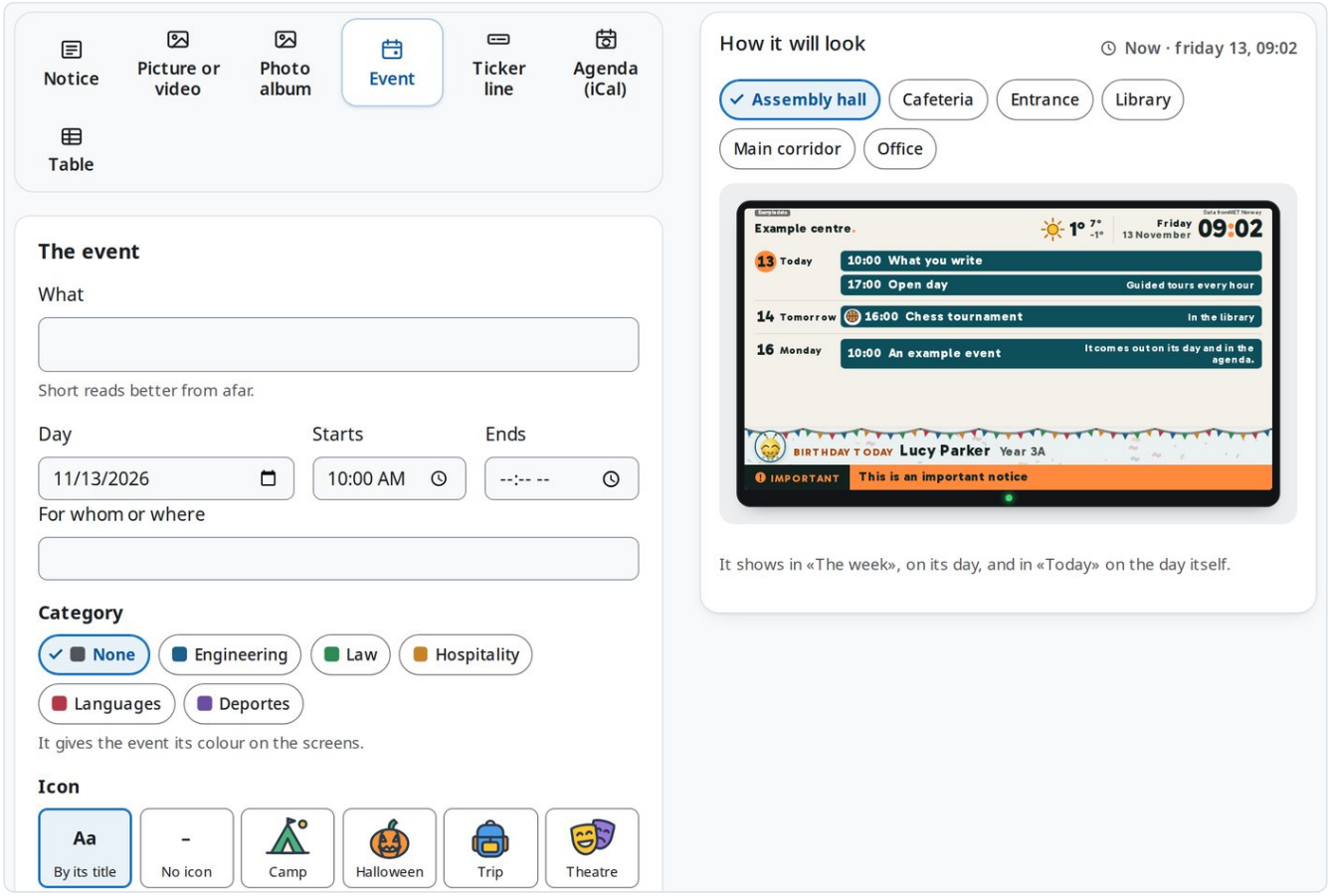


A photo, with «How it comes out».

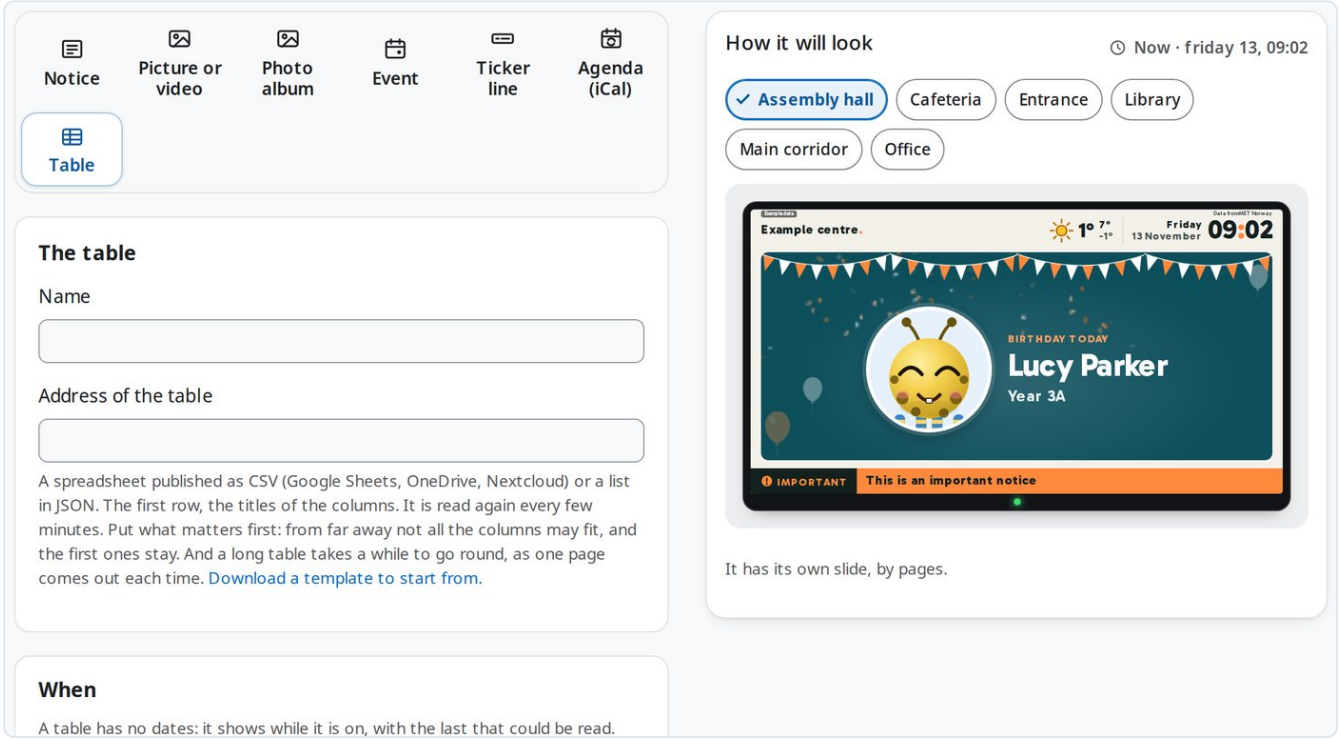
When and where

Each thing comes out **when** you say: from now on or between two dates, on some days of the week, at some hours, every week or every few weeks. And **where**: on all the screens, in one or several groups, or on single screens.

A notice can also be published **in the site news**: once, when it is saved, and Moodle sends it by email or to the phone of whoever follows that forum.



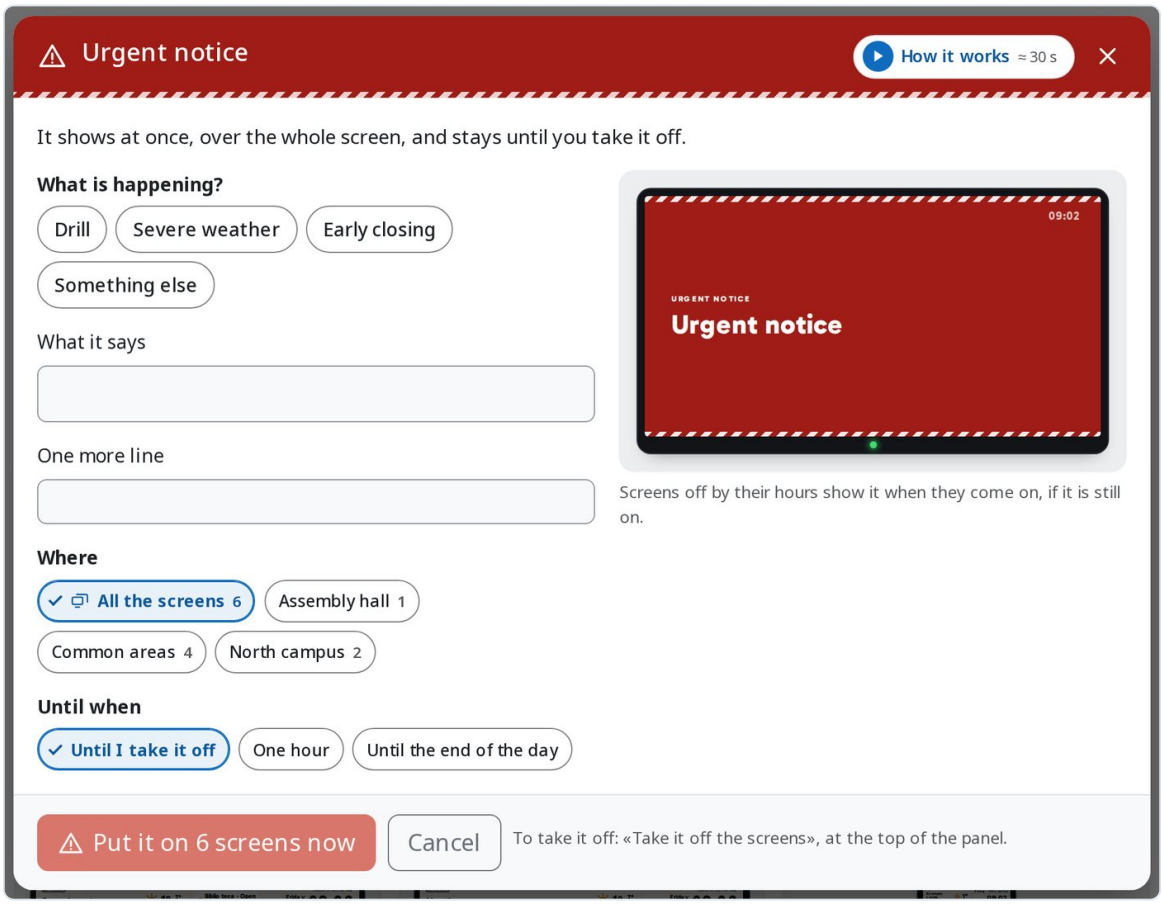
An event.



A table, with its model.

The urgent notice

For what cannot wait (a drill, a closure, a last-minute change), **Urgent notice** takes the whole screen at once and stays until you take it off, for an hour or until the end of the day. It can go to all the screens or only to some. Screens switched off by their hours show it when they come on, if it is still up.



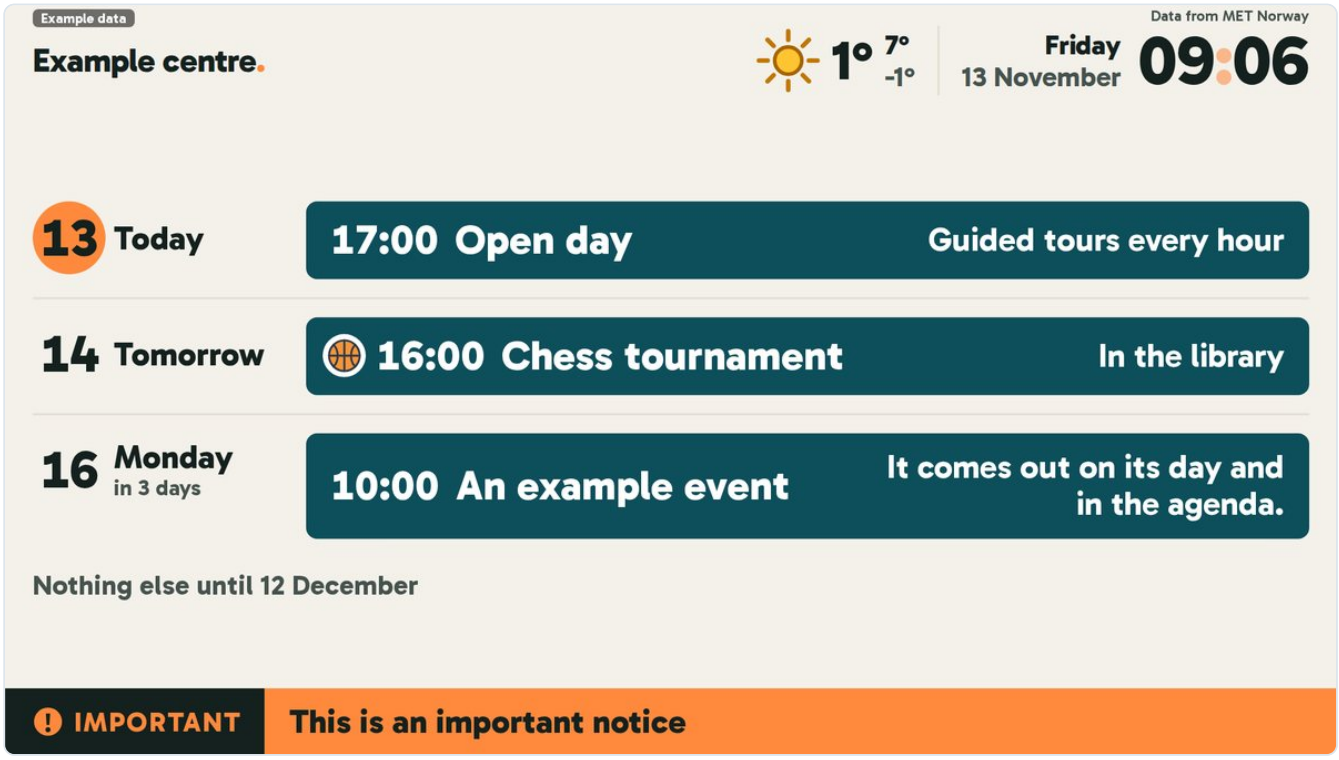
The urgent notice, with the screen beside it.

What comes by itself

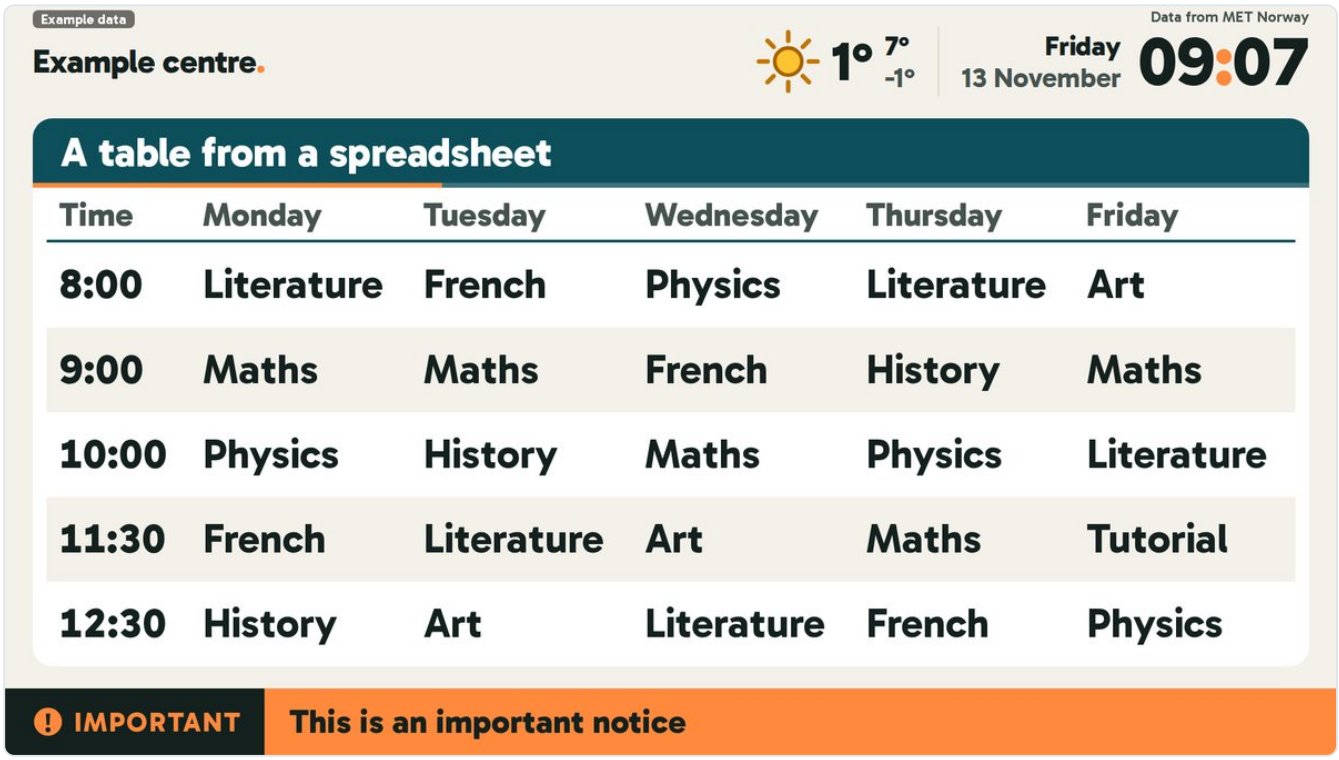
The screens do not wait for someone to publish. Without typing anything, they show:

- **The site calendar** and, on the screens of a group tied to a course category, its events too.
- **The site news.**
- **The menu of the day**, with its allergens, if the centre uses Oksigenia Meals. With several menus, a slide shows them all, each with its letter large, and it comes often while the canteen serves.
- **What is new in the library**, if the centre uses Oksigenia Ayvurenda.
- **The picture of the day**: a curious or beautiful picture each day (a galaxy, a bug under the microscope, a painting), chosen by hand by Oksigenia and right for children, with its caption and its author. In «Your centre», its themes.
- **What the library celebrates** that week, with Ayvurenda and without anyone’s name: the books lent this year, a book reaching its hundredth loan, the busiest day or readers reaching the goal of a challenge.
- **The assignments and quizzes** due in the coming days.
- **The birthdays**, if they are switched on.
- **The weather** where the centre is.

Each source is switched on or off in «Get started».



The agenda of the coming days.



A table from a spreadsheet.

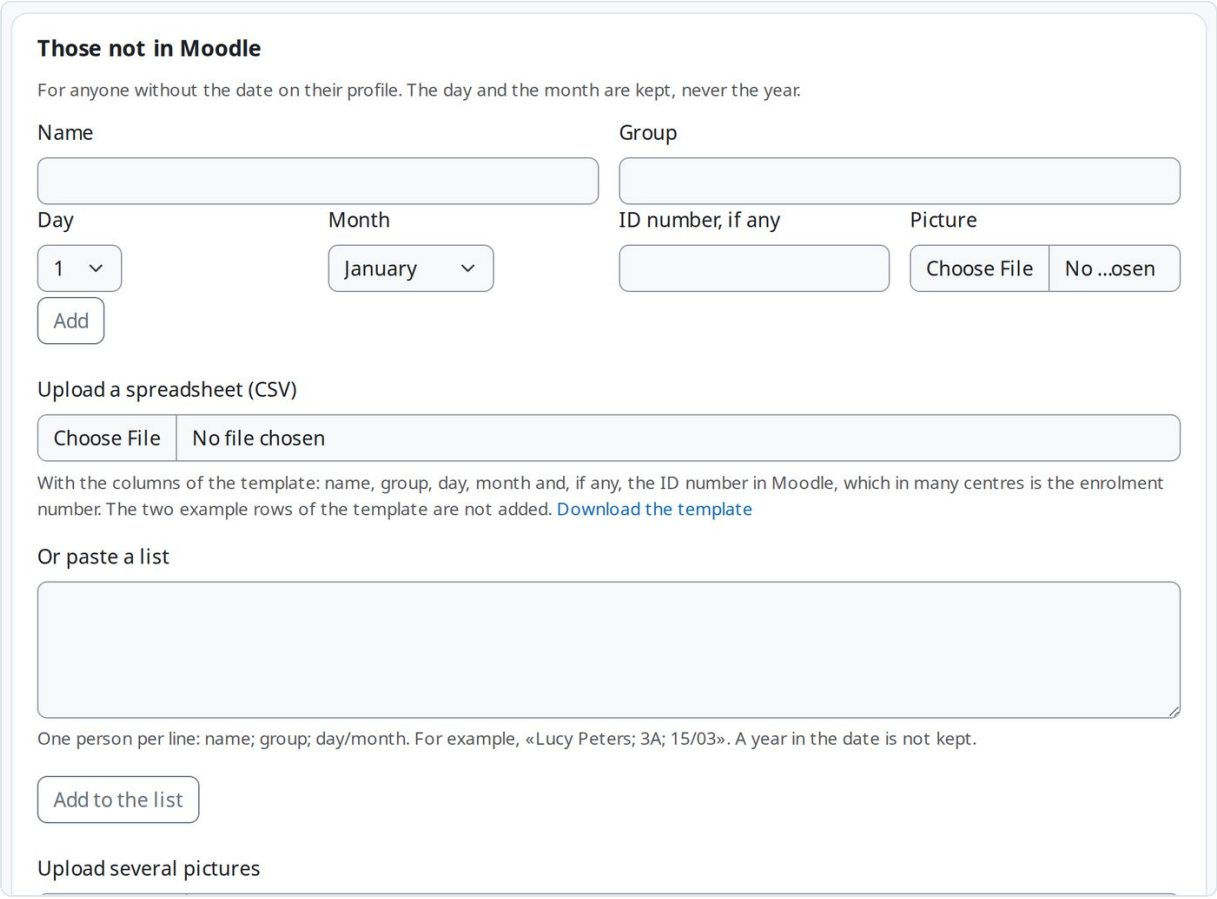
Birthdays

In **Your centre → Manage birthdays**. The screens congratulate whoever has a birthday, with their name, their group and their photo. Never the age, and never on a showcase screen. Off by default.

- Whoever is in Moodle comes out with the date of a profile field, if the site has one, and with their profile picture.
- For everyone else there is a **list**: one at a time, pasting a list or **uploading a spreadsheet** with the columns of the model you download right there (name, group, day, month and, if any, the ID number in Moodle).
- **The photos** are uploaded all at once: each file with the name of the person («Lucy Parker.jpg») or with their ID number («1024.jpg»). In many centres, the ID number in Moodle is the enrolment number.

On the day someone has a birthday, besides their turn of celebration, a band congratulates them all day long under whatever is showing, one by one if there are several.

The day and the month are kept, never the year.



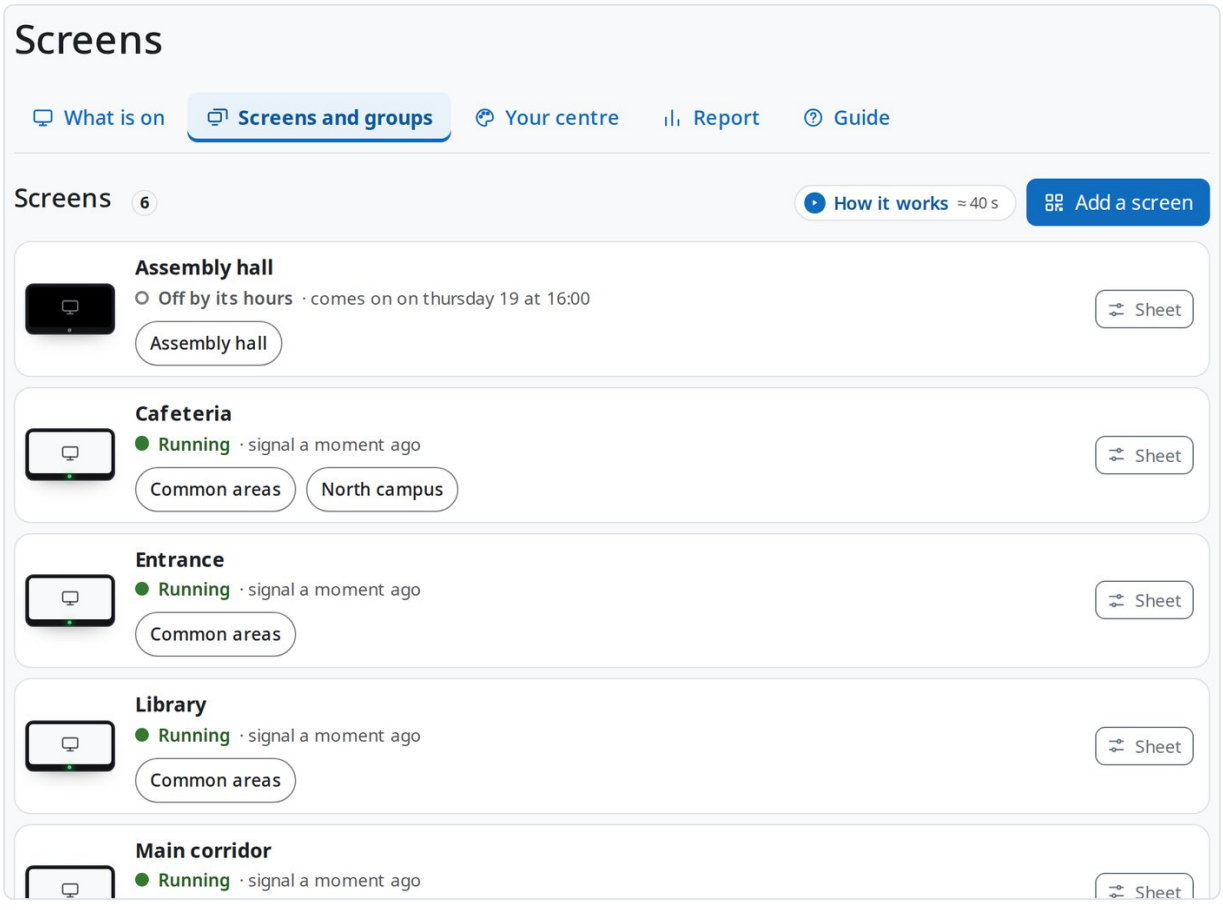
The birthdays page.



And what the screen shows.

Screens and groups

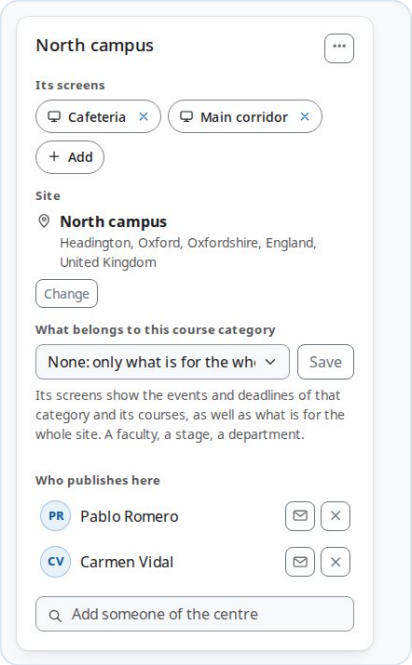
Here are all the screens, with their state, and the groups.



Screens and groups.

A **group** puts screens together to publish on all of them at once: those of a floor, of a building, of the cafeteria. A screen can be in several groups. Each group can:

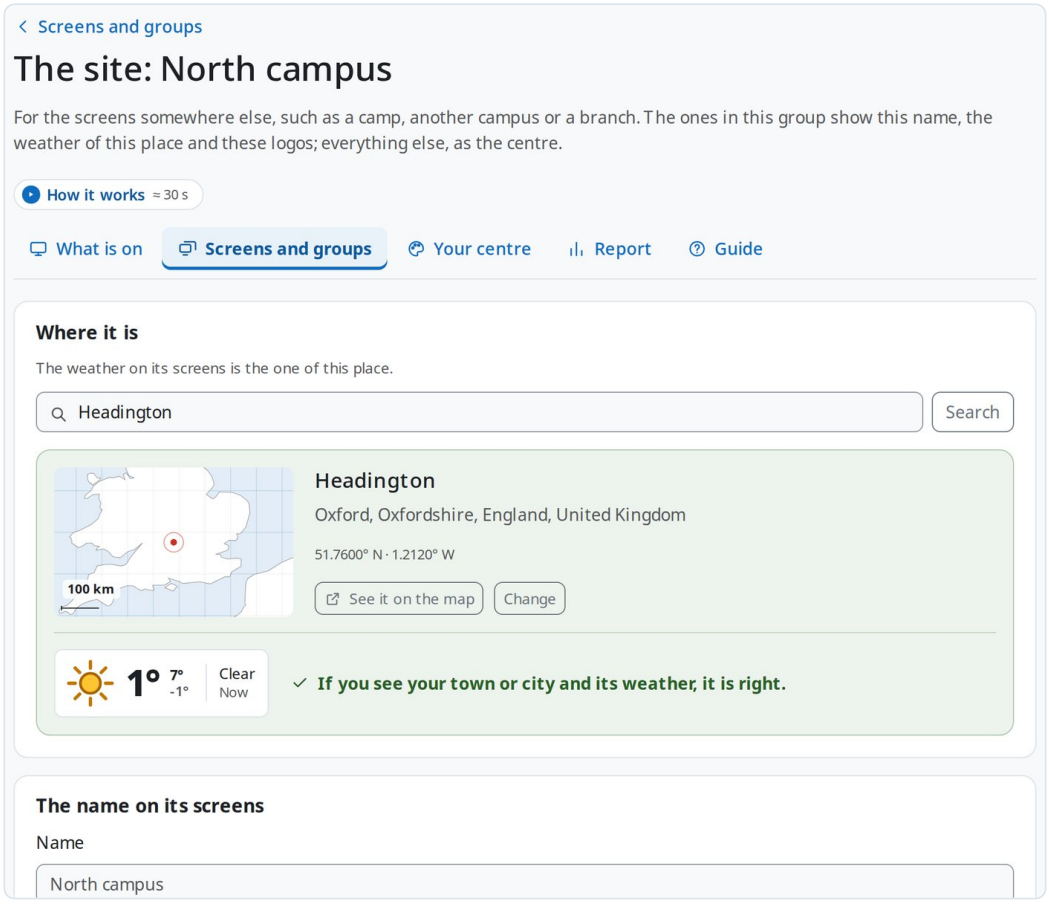
- **be tied to a course category** in Moodle (a faculty, a stage, a department), so that its screens also show the events and deadlines of that category;
- **be a site**, if its screens are somewhere else;
- have **someone who publishes on it**, and only on it.



A group that is a site.

Sites

A campus, a branch or a camp in another town: a group can have **its own name, its place (and with it its weather) and its logo**. Its screens take them instead of the centre's; everything else, as the centre. It opens from the group's card, with **Is it somewhere else?**



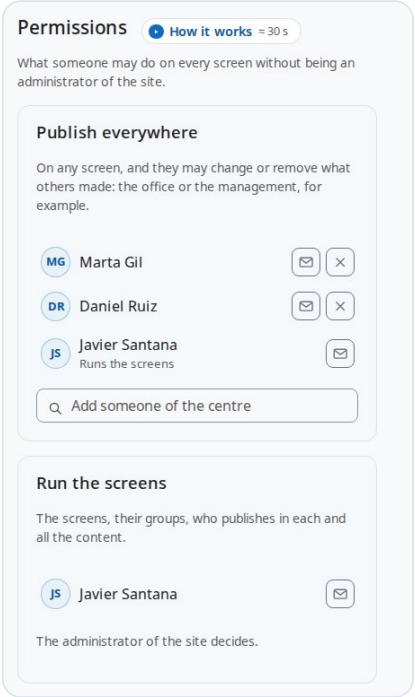
The page of a site.

Who does what

Nobody needs to be a Moodle administrator to run the screens. Everything is handed out in **Screens and groups**, with a people search:

- **Run the screens**: they add the screens, their hours and their groups, decide who publishes where and get the warnings when a screen goes down. The site administrator chooses them.
- **Publish everywhere**: on any screen, and they can change or take off what others published. The office or the management, for example.
- **Publish in a group**: only on the screens of that group, and they only see those screens and what they publish themselves. For example, whoever runs a club, a department or a site.

Giving a permission tells nobody. When you want the person to know, the envelope beside their name sends them a notice from you, with the panel and this guide.

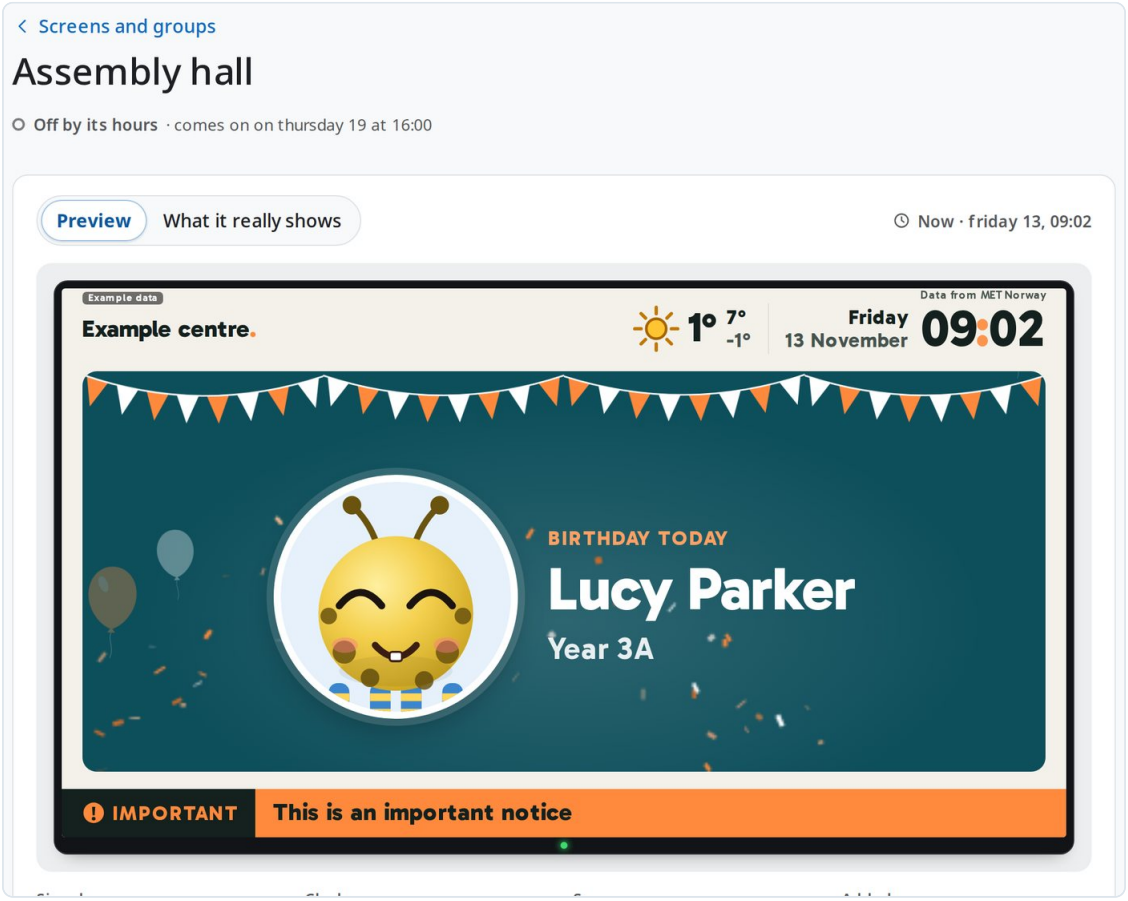


The permissions.

Each screen’s sheet

Each screen has its sheet, with what it shows now (and a capture of what it really shows, if it has the Hechauka device), its state, its name and its groups, and:

- **What it is for.** Informative (what is on at the centre, with the fixed notice and the ticker), **showcase** (large photos and videos, for the street or an entrance) or mixed. It can change at some hours.
- **Where it is read from.** Close (about 3 m), middle distance (about 5 m) or from afar (8 m or more), and whether it is behind glass. The size of the letter and how much fits at once change by themselves.
- **Its hours.** Outside them, the screen switches off by itself if the device can, and it does not count as down.
- **Its place and its hours.** If it is in a place with opening hours (the library, the canteen), the screen says beside the clock whether it is open and until when, or when it opens, and now and then shows the week’s hours. The days it closes, such as bank holidays, are added apart.
- **Reload**, if it is ever needed.

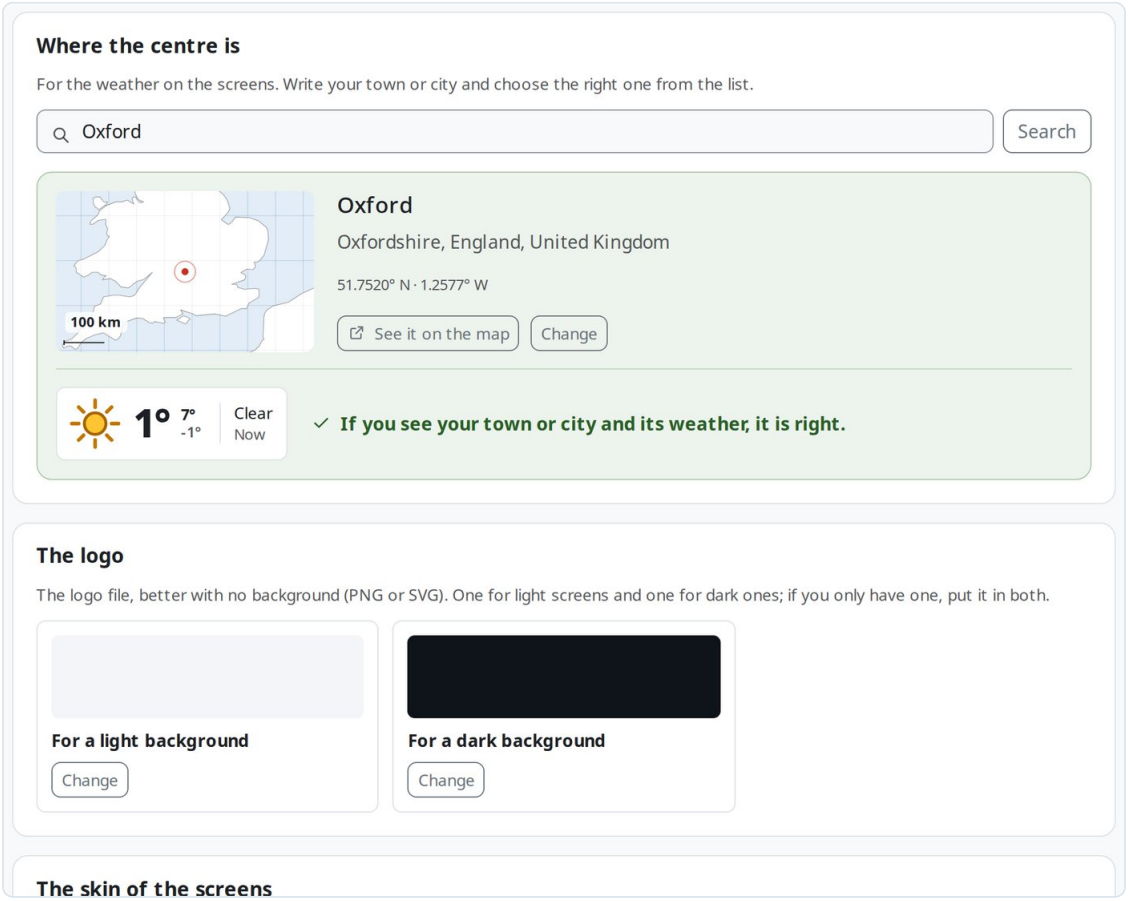


The sheet of a screen.

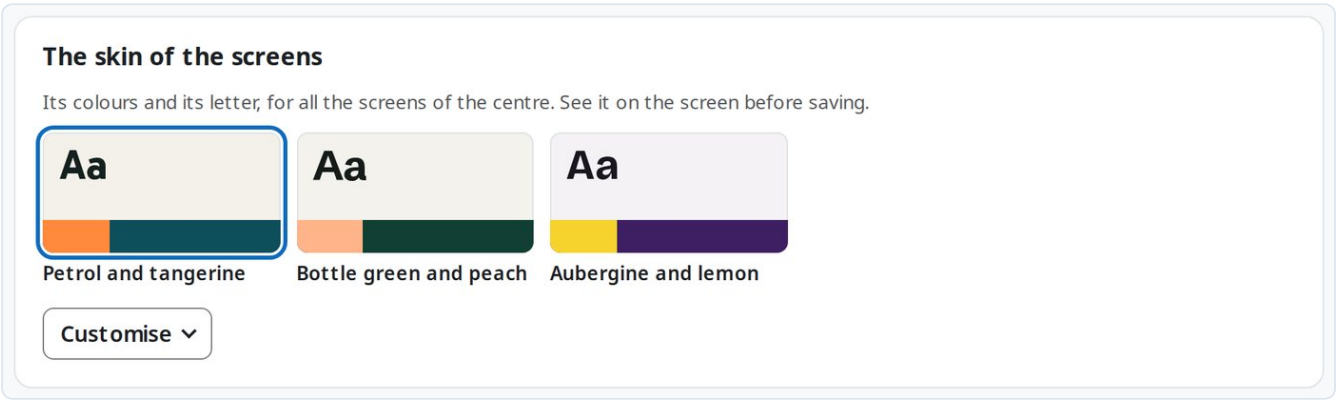
Your centre

What makes the screens the centre's, and not Hechauka's:

- **Where it is**, for the weather.
- **The logo**, one for a light background and one for a dark one.
- **The skin**: the colours and the letter of all the screens. There are several, and **Customise** adapts any of them to your centre (colours, background, letter and corners), always with tested combinations that read from afar.
- **The colours of the centre** and the **theme**, light, dark or by the hour.
- **The categories**, up to six, to colour the events by whom they are for, or brought from the course categories.
- **The day**: at what time the screens start showing tomorrow; with Oksigenia Meals, when the canteen serves; and how many videos each screen shows a day (two by default): if there are more, they take turns, other ones each day.
- **The centre's sentence**: its motto, whole in the ticker every few sentences and with the logo.
- **The surprises**: now and then, a character crosses the screen. Off by default.



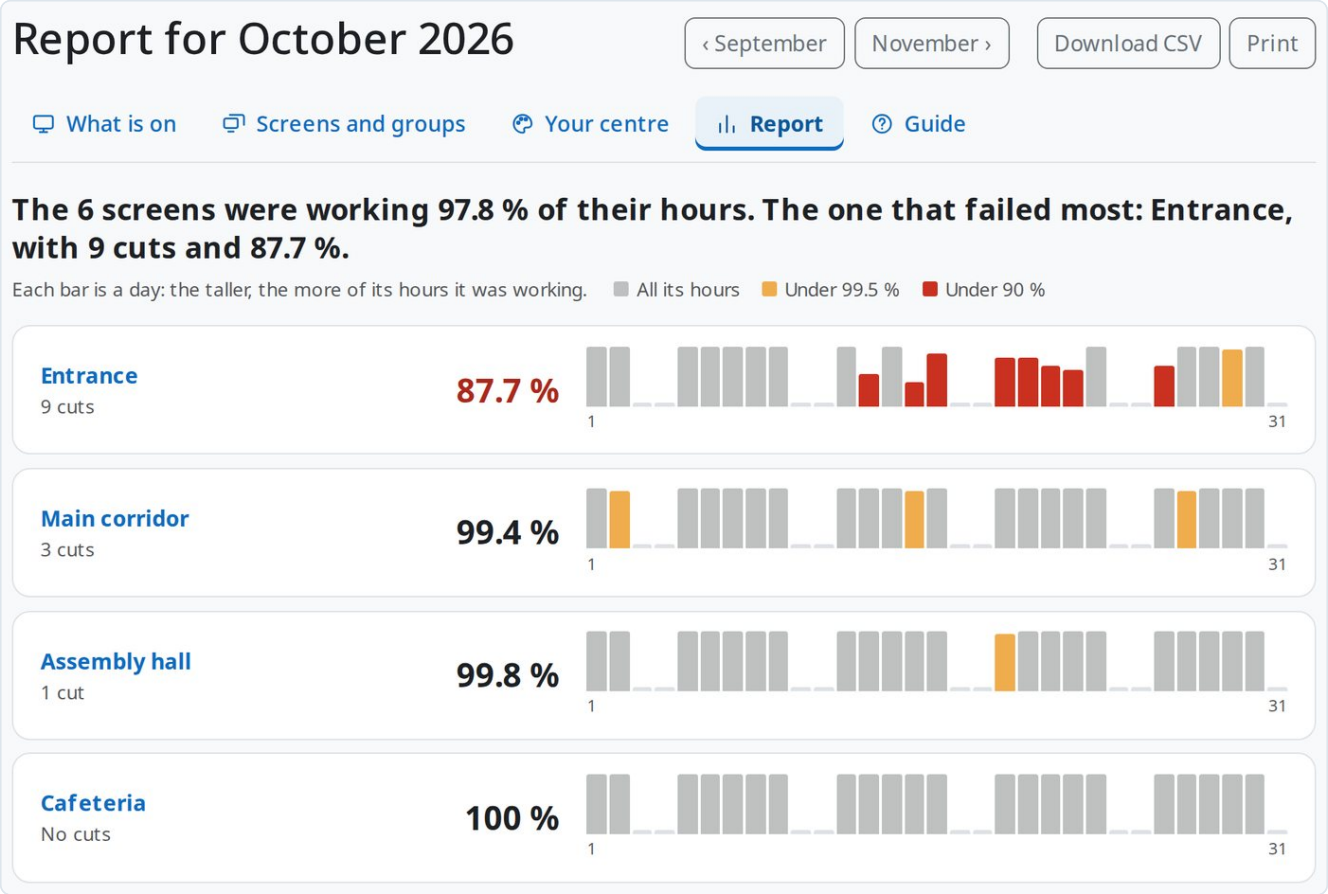
Your centre.



The skins and the surprises.

The monthly report

The **Report** tab says, month by month, how much of its hours each screen was running, day by day; its longest cuts; and what came out and how many times. The first sentence names the screen that failed most. It can be downloaded as CSV or printed, and on the 1st of each month a message reaches whoever runs the screens.



The report of a month.

If something does not work

- **A screen with «no signal».** Check that it is on and connected to the internet. If a screen that should be on stops giving signs of life, whoever runs the screens gets a warning, and another when it comes back.
- **Something published does not come out.** Check in its row **when** and **where** it comes out, and that it is published and not just saved. The preview of each screen shows what it has now.
- **A video takes a while.** It is prepared on the server before reaching the screens; meanwhile, it does not come out.
- **An agenda or a table cannot be read.** The address has to be published, without asking to sign in. The panel says when it was last read.

Without a network for a while, a screen goes on showing the last thing it received.

For whoever installs it

- The plugin is installed like any other Moodle plugin. The technical settings (among them, the tool that prepares the videos, `ffmpeg`) are in the site administration.
- For each screen a modern browser in kiosk mode is enough. With the Hechauka device (a Raspberry Pi or a mini computer), the television also switches on and off with its hours, you can see what it really shows, and it recovers by itself if something hangs.
- The technical details and the guide for each centre’s developers are in the plugin’s repository. Oksigenia Hechauka is free software (GNU GPL v3), by Oksigenia SL: oksigenia.com.